

CHESS COACH READY™

Tournament Game-Day Preparation Builder™

Complete systems for preparing tournaments and planning competition strategy.



WELCOME

What This Bonus Delivers

Tournament weekends expose every gap in a coach's preparation system. Last-minute scrambles, forgotten logistics, inconsistent post-game reviews — this bonus eliminates all of it. Instead of improvising, you'll work from a structured, repeatable system that travels with you to every event.

The Problem It Solves

No consistent framework for tracking a student across a multi-round tournament weekend — from entry logistics through post-event review.

What You'll Walk Away With

Fillable templates covering every phase: pre-tournament planning, round-by-round tracking, in-game observation, and post-tournament analysis.

Who It's Built For

Coaches preparing students at any competitive level — scholastic, club, or open-section events with rated or unrated sections.

- ☐ Bonus 1 • Tournament Game-Day Preparation Builder™

Works Hand-in-Hand with Module 5

This bonus is the action layer for **Module 5: Tournament Strategy & Competition System™**. Where Module 5 teaches the principles — pacing across rounds, psychological resilience, competitive mindset — this builder provides the fillable instruments that put those principles to work for a specific, real upcoming tournament.

Module 5 Provides

- Strategic frameworks for competition
- Psychological preparation principles
- Tournament pacing methodology
- Post-event learning philosophy

This Bonus Provides

- Fillable templates for every phase
- Round-by-round tracking sheets
- Pre-round checklists with mental cues
- Worked example of the full system

Use these templates sequentially for each tournament. Over time, completed builder packets become a longitudinal record of your student's competitive development — one of the most valuable coaching assets you can build.

 Bonus 1 · Tournament Game-Day Preparation Builder™

Tournament Entry & Logistics Builder

Complete this template the moment registration is confirmed — at minimum two weeks before the event. Incomplete logistics information is the leading cause of preventable tournament-day stress. Fill every field; leave nothing for memory.

Event Details

Tournament Name:

Date(s):

Venue Name & Address:

Organizer Contact:

Format & Time Control

Section Entered:

Time Control:

_____ (e.g., G/60+5, G/90+30)

Pairing System: ☒ Swiss

☒ Round Robin ☒

Accelerated Swiss

Number of Rounds:

Rating & Registration

Student's Current Rating:

_____ (USCF / FIDE / Unrated)

Registration

Confirmed: ☒ Yes ☒ No

☒ On-site registration

Confirmation Number / ID:

Entry Fee Paid: ☒ Yes

☒ No



Arrival & Day-of Logistics

Travel & Arrival

Departure Time:

Estimated Arrival:

Travel Method:

Parking / Transit Notes:

Equipment

Chess Set Required: ☒

Yes ☒ No

Clock Required: ☒ Yes ☒

No

Scoresheets: ☒ Provided

☒ Bring own

Student ID Required: ☒

Yes ☒ No

Meals & Schedule

Round 1 Start Time:

Round Schedule /
Cadence:

Meal Plan (on-site /
packed):

Late Registration
Deadline:

Worked Example: Event: Westside Open Scholastic | Date: Saturday, March 15 | Venue: Downtown Community Center, 400 Main St | Section: K-8 U800 | Time Control: G/60+5 | Rounds: 5 Swiss | Arrival Target: 8:30 AM (Round 1 at 9:00 AM) | Clock: Bring own Chronos | Entry Fee: Paid online, Conf. #WS-2024-0887



Opponent & Field Research Builder

Use this template when pre-tournament pairing data, rating lists, or prior game records are available. Log only verified information — speculation without a basis in actual prior games is counterproductive. Leave fields blank when data is unavailable rather than estimating.

Opponent Name / ID	Rating	Likely 1.e4 / 1.d4 Repertoire	Known Tendencies	Priority to Study
				☒ High ☒ Med ☒ Low
				☒ High ☒ Med ☒ Low
				☒ High ☒ Med ☒ Low
				☒ High ☒ Med ☒ Low
				☒ High ☒ Med ☒ Low



Field Strength Assessment

Field Overview

Top Seed Rating: _____

Average Rating in Section:

Number of Players in Section:

Student's Expected Seed Position:

Rating Range of Section:

_____ to _____

Pre-Tournament Strategic Notes

Realistic Result Target: _____

Stretch Result Target: _____

Key opponents to prepare for:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Overall field assessment: ☒ Weaker ☒ Even

☒ Stronger than student

Worked Example: Top Seed: 892 | Avg Rating: 640 | Players: 24 | Student Seed: ~8th | Realistic Target: 3/5 | Stretch Target: 4/5 | Key Opponents: Player rated 810 (likely early round 4 or 5 pairing — known to play King's Indian Defense as Black). Field: Roughly even with student's current level.



Repertoire Selection Builder

This template connects directly to the prepared lines from **Module 3**. The goal is not to learn new openings before an event — it is to select, confirm, and refresh the student's existing prepared lines for this specific event's expected challenges. Focus narrows; confidence concentrates.

As White — Primary Weapon

**Opening System
Selected:**

**Primary Variation to
Reach:**

**Key Ideas / Plans to
Review:**

Refresh Method: ☐
 Game review ☐ Drill ☐
 Puzzle set ☐ Coach
 walkthrough
Confidence Level: ☐
 Strong ☐ Adequate ☐
 Needs work

As Black vs. 1.e4 — Primary Defense

Defense Selected:

Primary Variation:

**Key Ideas / Plans to
Review:**

Refresh Method: ☐
 Game review ☐ Drill ☐
 Puzzle set ☐ Coach
 walkthrough
Confidence Level: ☐
 Strong ☐ Adequate ☐
 Needs work

As Black vs. 1.d4 — Primary Defense

Defense Selected:

Primary Variation:

**Key Ideas / Plans to
Review:**

Refresh Method: ☐
 Game review ☐ Drill ☐
 Puzzle set ☐ Coach
 walkthrough
Confidence Level: ☐
 Strong ☐ Adequate ☐
 Needs work

Backup Lines & Unexpected Positions

Every competitive student should carry one reliable backup for each color — a solid, low-theory alternative to deploy when the opponent sidesteps the prepared main line. Log backup lines here and verify the student has reviewed them within two weeks of the event.

Scenario	Backup Line / System	Key Idea	Last Reviewed
White — opponent avoids main line	_____	_____	_____
Black vs. 1.e4 — sideline (e.g., 2.Nc3, Wing Gambit)	_____	_____	_____
Black vs. 1.d4 — sideline (e.g., London, Trompowsky)	_____	_____	_____
Black vs. Irregular (1.b4, 1.f4, 1.Nc3)	_____	_____	_____

Worked Example (White): Primary: Catalan Opening (1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 Nf6 4.g3). Backup: Queen's Gambit Exchange (1.d4 d5 2.c4 dxc4 3.e3) — low theory, reliable pawn structure, student knows this well from club practice. Last reviewed: 10 days before event.

Pre-Tournament Preparation Completion Checklist

Complete this checklist in the 48 hours before the event. Every unchecked item on tournament morning represents a risk that could have been eliminated in advance. Build the habit of arriving with this checklist fully resolved.

Logistics Confirmed

- ☐ Tournament registration confirmed and printed/saved
- ☐ Venue address and parking researched
- ☐ Departure time set with buffer for traffic
- ☐ Equipment packed: clock, scoresheets, pencils, set (if required)
- ☐ Student ID / membership card located
- ☐ Meal plan confirmed (on-site or packed food)
- ☐ Emergency contact for venue organizer saved

Chess Preparation Confirmed

- ☐ White opening lines reviewed (primary + backup)
- ☐ Black vs. 1.e4 lines reviewed (primary + backup)
- ☐ Black vs. 1.d4 lines reviewed (primary + backup)
- ☐ Known opponent tendencies reviewed (if applicable)
- ☐ Student's endgame fundamentals spot-checked
- ☐ Pre-round mental routine reviewed with student
- ☐ Goal for the event discussed and confirmed with student

Round-by-Round Tracking Sheet

Complete one row immediately after each round — while the position and key moments are still fresh. The one-line note is not a game annotation; it is a single high-priority observation to revisit in the post-tournament review. Brevity here is intentional.



Round Tracker — All Rounds

Rd	Opponent Name	Opp. Rating	Color	Result	Score After	One-Line Note (Critical Moment / Lesson)
1	_____ _____ —	_____	☒W ☒B	☒W ☒D ☒L	____/1	_____ _____ —
2	_____ _____ —	_____	☒W ☒B	☒W ☒D ☒L	____/2	_____ _____ —
3	_____ _____ —	_____	☒W ☒B	☒W ☒D ☒L	____/3	_____ _____ —
4	_____ _____ —	_____	☒W ☒B	☒W ☒D ☒L	____/4	_____ _____ —
5	_____ _____ —	_____	☒W ☒B	☒W ☒D ☒L	____/5	_____ _____ —
6	_____ _____ —	_____	☒W ☒B	☒W ☒D ☒L	____/6	_____ _____ —
7	_____ _____ —	_____	☒W ☒B	☒W ☒D ☒L	____/7	_____ _____ —

Final Score: _____/_____ Place / Prize: _____ Estimated Rating Change: _____

Pre-Round Checklist Builder

This checklist combines tournament logistics with the mental-readiness cues from **Module 4**. The student should complete the logistics half independently; the coach reviews the readiness half before the student enters the playing hall. Run this protocol before every round — not just Round 1.

Logistics (Student Completes)

- ☐ Board number located on pairing sheet
- ☐ Opponent's name and color confirmed
- ☐ Clock set and verified with tournament director if unclear
- ☐ Scoresheet written out: student name, opponent name, color, round, date
- ☐ Phone off or in bag — not on person
- ☐ Water bottle / snack accessible (if permitted in playing hall)
- ☐ Restroom stop taken before entering hall

Readiness Cues (Coach Reviews with Student)

- ☐ Goal for this round stated aloud ("I am playing for quality moves and managing my clock.")
- ☐ Opening first 5–8 moves mentally reviewed
- ☐ Time control reminder: when to pick up the pace vs. slow down
- ☐ One positive anchor from a previous game recalled
- ☐ Breathing reset: 3 deep breaths before sitting at the board
- ☐ Exit plan confirmed: student knows where coach will be after the round

Between-Round Protocol

What happens between rounds often determines the quality of the next game. An unstructured 30-minute break can be wasted on distraction or erosive post-mortem commentary. Use this structured protocol to protect the student's energy and focus between rounds.

1**Minutes 1–5**

Physical reset: leave the playing hall, get water, light movement. No chess talk — let the nervous system settle after the completed game.

2**Minutes 6–15**

Brief coach debrief: one question only — "What was the key moment?" Log the student's answer in the Round Tracker. Avoid analysis rabbit holes.

3**Minutes 16–25**

Light refuel (food/water), quiet mental downtime. No engine analysis, no reviewing other people's games unless student requests it and energy is high.

4**Minutes 26–30**

Run the Pre-Round Checklist for the next round. Student enters the hall calm, confirmed, and ready — not rushed.



In-Game Time & Decision Log

This template is for coach observation from the tournament hall, or for the student to complete from memory immediately after the game. It is not a scoresheet replacement — it is a decision-quality audit focused on the clock and critical junctures. Use it to identify time-pressure patterns and decision-making under constraint.

Game Header

Round: _____ **Color:**

☐ White ☐ Black

Opponent Rating:

Opening Reached:

Result: ☐ Win ☐ Draw ☐ Loss

Clock Usage

Time on clock at move

20: _____

Time on clock at move

30: _____

Time on clock at move

40: _____

Time pressure moment?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes — move number:

Critical Decision Points

Key moment #1 — Move

_____:

Position type (tactical / strategic / endgame):

Student's decision:

Assessment: ☐ Good ☐

Questionable ☐ Error



In-Game Log — Extended Decision Capture

Move #	Position Type	Time Spent (approx.)	Student's Decision	Quality Flag	Note for Review
_____	☐ Tactical ☐ Strategic ☐ Endgame	_____ min	_____ _____	☐ Good ☐ ? ☐ Error	_____ _____
_____	☐ Tactical ☐ Strategic ☐ Endgame	_____ min	_____ _____	☐ Good ☐ ? ☐ Error	_____ _____
_____	☐ Tactical ☐ Strategic ☐ Endgame	_____ min	_____ _____	☐ Good ☐ ? ☐ Error	_____ _____
_____	☐ Tactical ☐ Strategic ☐ Endgame	_____ min	_____ _____	☐ Good ☐ ? ☐ Error	_____ _____

Worked Example: Move 24 — Strategic (rook placement decision) — 9 minutes spent — Student placed rook on open d-file (correct plan) — Quality: Good — Note: Student correctly identified the plan but took too long; target under 4 minutes for this type of decision at G/60 time control. Flag for time-management drill.

Game-Day Summary Snapshot

At the close of each tournament day, complete this single-page snapshot. This is a coach-facing document — a rapid assessment of the student's competitive state heading into the next day (or into post-tournament review if it's a single-day event).

Performance Snapshot

Rounds played today:

Score today:

_____/_____

Cumulative score:

_____/_____

**Strongest game today
(round #):** _____

**Weakest game today
(round #):** _____

Opening Performance

Primary white line held

up: ☒ Yes ☒ Partially ☒

Sidestepped

Black vs. 1.e4 line held

up: ☒ Yes ☒ Partially ☒

Sidestepped

Black vs. 1.d4 line held

up: ☒ Yes ☒ Partially ☒

Sidestepped

Backup line used: ☒ Yes

☒ No — Which: _____

Energy & Readiness for Tomorrow

Physical energy level

(1–5): _____

Mental focus level (1–

5): _____

**One adjustment for
tomorrow:**

**One thing to reinforce
tomorrow:**



Game-by-Game Analysis Builder

Schedule the post-tournament review session within 72 hours of the event — ideally within 48 hours, before game memories fade and scoresheet notation becomes ambiguous. Use one analysis template per game. The purpose is not exhaustive engine analysis; it is identifying the critical moment and extracting one clear, actionable lesson.



Game Analysis Template (One Per Game)

Field	Entry
Round #	_____
Color	☐ White ☐ Black
Result	☐ Win ☐ Draw ☐ Loss
Opening Played	_____
Opening Phase Assessment	☐ Comfortable ☐ Slightly off ☐ Out of preparation
Game Phase Where Result Was Decided	☐ Opening ☐ Middlegame ☐ Endgame ☐ Time pressure
Critical Moment (describe position or move #)	_____
Student's Decision at Critical Moment	_____
Better Continuation (from analysis)	_____
Concept Behind Better Move	☐ Piece activity ☐ Pawn structure ☐ King safety ☐ Calculation depth ☐ Endgame technique ☐ Other: _____
Primary Lesson for Training	_____
Module / Skill Area to Address	☐ Module 1 ☐ Module 2 ☐ Module 3 ☐ Module 4 ☐ Module 5 ☐ Other

Tournament Summary Report Builder

This one-page summary is designed to be shared with the student, and optionally with parents or guardians. It translates tournament results into coaching language — specific, accurate, and forward-looking. Avoid vague praise; avoid overly critical framing. The report must communicate clearly to a non-chess audience while remaining precise for the student.

Event Summary

Tournament: _____

Date: _____

Section: _____

Number of Rounds: _____

Final Score: _____ / _____

Final Place: _____

Rating Update

Rating Before Event: _____

Estimated Rating After: _____

Estimated Change: _____ points

Rating Direction: ☒ Increase ☒ Decrease ☐

No change

Performance Rating this event: _____

Strengths Demonstrated

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Areas for Development

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Parent/Guardian Summary Narrative

Complete this narrative section for the student summary report. Write in complete sentences. This section is read by non-coaches — use clear, accessible language without sacrificing accuracy.

Overall Assessment (2–3 sentences)

What the Student Did Well (be specific)

What We Will Work On Next

Next Recommended Tournament / Training Milestone

Suggested next event:

Suggested timing:

Training focus between now and then:

Worked Example (Overall Assessment): "Jordan competed in a 5-round Swiss section and finished with 3.5/5, gaining an estimated 18 rating points. The strongest performances came in rounds 2 and 4, where Jordan demonstrated excellent opening preparation and clean tactical execution in the middlegame. Time management in longer positions remains the primary area for development going forward."

Next-Steps Planning Builder

This is the bridge from tournament findings to the next training block. Complete it in the same post-tournament review session as the game analysis. Every finding without a concrete next step is lost intelligence. Map each lesson directly to a module, skill area, or training drill.

Tournament Finding	Specific Skill Gap Identified	Training Response	Module / Link	Target Date
_____	_____	_____	☒ Mod 1 ☒ 2 ☒ 3 ☒ 4 ☒ 5	_____
_____	_____	_____	☒ Mod 1 ☒ 2 ☒ 3 ☒ 4 ☒ 5	_____
_____	_____	_____	☒ Mod 1 ☒ 2 ☒ 3 ☒ 4 ☒ 5	_____
_____	_____	_____	☒ Mod 1 ☒ 2 ☒ 3 ☒ 4 ☒ 5	_____

Primary Training Goal — Next 4 Weeks

Success measure:

Secondary Training Goal — Next 4 Weeks

Success measure:

Next Competitive Milestone

Next event target:

Rating goal by then:

Performance goal:

Full Sample Tournament Weekend

The following two pages walk through a complete, realistic sample tournament weekend using every builder in this bonus — from entry confirmation through post-tournament next-steps planning. All names, ratings, and events are illustrative only. Use this example as a reference model for your first time through the system.



Sample Weekend: Filled-Out Snapshots

Logistics Builder (Sample)

Event: Regional Scholastic Open

Section: K-12 Under 1000

Time Control: G/60+5

Rounds: 5 Swiss

Venue: University Recreation Center

Arrival Target: 8:45 AM

Round 1 Start: 9:30 AM

Equipment: Clock packed, scoresheets provided, ID confirmed

Round Tracker (Sample)

Rd 1: vs. 642 | White | Win | 1/1 | "Excellent Catalan setup, smooth transition to endgame"

Rd 2: vs. 781 | Black | Loss | 1/2 | "Missed piece fork on move 19 — tactical alert needed"

Rd 3: vs. 598 | White | Win | 2/3 | "Good clock management, technique clean in K+P ending"

Rd 4: vs. 710 | Black | Draw | 2.5/4 | "Held difficult rook endgame — showed resilience"

Rd 5: vs. 653 | White | Win | 3.5/5 | "Used backup QGE line when opponent avoided Catalan"

Game Analysis — Round 2 (Sample)

Color: Black | **Result:** Loss

Opening: Sicilian Kan (student's prepared line)

Opening phase: Comfortable through move 14

Result decided: Middlegame

Critical moment: Move 19 — opponent's knight on e4 was hanging to a discovered bishop attack

Student's decision: Played passive Qd7 — missed the tactical sequence

Better continuation: 19...Bxe4 20.fxe4 Qxe4+ winning material

Concept: Calculation depth — failed to scan for piece captures before defensive moves

Lesson: Pre-move checklist: always ask "can I capture something?" before retreating

Module link: Module 2 (Tactical Vision)

Next-Steps Planning (Sample)

Finding: Missed tactical shots in critical positions

Skill gap: Forcing-move calculation at move 15–25 middlegame

Training response: 20 tactical puzzles/week emphasizing piece captures and discovered attacks

Module: Module 2

Target date: 3 weeks

Primary goal: Convert material advantages in 80% of winning positions within 4 weeks

Build the Habit. Trust the System.

Every template in this bonus becomes more valuable with each tournament you run through it. The first time, you're learning the system. By the fifth event, you're operating at a level of preparation that separates serious coaches from everyone else in the room.

What This Bonus Delivers

A complete, repeatable tournament-preparation infrastructure — from registration confirmation through post-event training adjustments.

How It Complements Module 5

Module 5 teaches the strategy. This bonus provides the operational tools — the exact instruments that put that strategy into practice for every real tournament your student enters.

Your Next Step

Open the Logistics Builder. Enter your student's next upcoming tournament. Run the system from page one. The preparation habit starts with the next event on the calendar.

The coaches who build the most consistent, confident competitors are not the ones who know the most theory — they are the ones who prepare the most deliberately. This system is your preparation infrastructure. Use it every time.